

Math 242, S15
Quiz 6

Name: Answer
SSN: xxx-xx-

Instructions: There is totally 1 problem. You must show all of your work to receive a credit for a correct answer.

Problem 1. (10 points) Suppose that a motorboat is moving at 50 ft/s when its motor suddenly quits at time $t = 0$, and that 10 s later the boat has slowed to 25 ft/s. Assume that the resistance it encounters while coasting is proportional to its velocity, i.e., $\frac{dv}{dt} = -kv$.
(a) Find the velocity $v(t)$ of the motorboat at time t .

$$\begin{cases} \frac{dv}{dt} = -kv \\ v(0) = 50 \end{cases}$$

$$\frac{1}{v} dv = -k dt$$

$$\ln|v| = -kt + C$$

$$\Rightarrow |v| = e^{-kt+C}$$

$$v(t) = Ae^{-kt}$$

$$v(0) = 50 \Rightarrow 50 = Ae^0$$

$$A = 50$$

$$\Rightarrow v(t) = 50e^{-kt}$$

In addition

$$v(10) = 25 \Rightarrow 25 = 50e^{-10k}$$

$$e^{-10k} = \frac{1}{2}$$

$$k = \left(-\frac{1}{10}\right) \ln\left(\frac{1}{2}\right) = \frac{\ln 2}{10} \approx 0.0693$$

Thus

$$v(t) = 50e^{-\frac{\ln 2}{10}t}$$

(b) Find the distance $x(t)$ travelled by the motorboat at time t , and how far will the motorboat coast in all?

$$x(t) = \int_0^t v(s) ds = \int_0^t 50e^{-\frac{\ln 2}{10}s} ds$$

$$= \left[-\frac{500}{\ln 2} e^{-\frac{\ln 2}{10}s} \right]_{s=0}^{s=t}$$

$$= \frac{500}{\ln 2} (1 - e^{-\frac{\ln 2}{10}t})$$

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow \infty} v(t) = 0 \text{ and } v(t) > 0 \text{ for } t > 0.$$

Thus the distance the boat coast in all is

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow \infty} x(t) = \lim_{t \rightarrow \infty} \frac{500}{\ln 2} (1 - e^{-\frac{\ln 2}{10}t}) = \frac{500}{\ln 2} \approx 721.5 \text{ ft.}$$